

# CHENLONG ZHANG(张晨龙)

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## 🎓 EDUCATION

**Institute of Automation, Chinese Academy of Sciences, Beijing, China** 2023 – Present

M.S. in Pattern Recognition and Intelligent Systems (GPA: 3.82/4.0)

Supervised by Prof. [Yubo Chen](#) and Prof. [Jun Zhao](#)

**Henan University, Henan, China**

2019 – 2023

B.S. in Software Engineering (GPA: 3.84/4.0, Rank: 1/388)

## </> INTERNSHIPS

**Carnegie Mellon University**

Jun. 2025 - Nov. 2025

*Research Intern*, advised by [Xiang Yue](#) and [Graham Neubig](#)

**The Hong Kong University of Science and Technology (Guangzhou)** Feb. 2025 – May. 2025

*Research Intern*, advised by [Jiaheng Wei](#)

**NLPR, Institute of Automation, Chinese Academy of Sciences**

Sep. 2022 – Jul. 2023

*Research Intern*, advised by [Pengfei Cao](#)

## 💡 RESEARCH INTERESTS

**Understanding the mechanisms of reasoning LMs:** How do LMs compose complex reasoning patterns during pre-/mid-/post-training? What is the limit of reasoning LLMs for seemingly impossible tasks? What is the role of the environment for agentic reasoning?

**Understanding model-data interactions:** How to design efficient algorithms for language models in data- and supervision-limited conditions? How to remove hazardous/private data from LLMs?

**Event Modeling & Social Simulation with LLMs:** How do large language models model complex real-world events? Is there a way for LLMs to interact with the world? Can social simulation on complex events lead to better decision-making?

## 📖 PUBLICATIONS

1. **Chenlong Zhang**, Graham Neubig, and Xiang Yue. [On the Interplay of Pre-Training, Mid-Training, and RL on Reasoning Language Models](#)
2. Zhuoran Jin, Ruilin Xu, **Chenlong Zhang**, Yupu Hao, Kejian Zhu, Hongbang Yuan, Pengfei Cao, Daojian Zeng, Yubo Chen, Kang Liu, and Jun Zhao. [Pixels Lie, Code Doesn't: Thinking with Visual Programming for "Seemingly Impossible" Multimodal Agentic Reasoning Tasks](#). Submitted to **ICLR 2026**.
3. Jiachun Li, Shaoping Huang, Zhuoran Jin, **Chenlong Zhang**, Pengfei Cao, Yubo Chen, Kang Liu and Jun Zhao. [MMR-Life: Piecing Together Real-life Scenes for Multimodal Multi-image Reasoning](#). Submitted to **ICLR 2026**.
4. **Chenlong Zhang**, Zhuoran Jin, Hongbang Yuan, Jiaheng Wei, Tong Zhou, Kang Liu, Jun Zhao and Yubo Chen. [RULE: Reinforcement Unlearning Achieves Forget-retain Pareto Optimality](#). Accepted to **NeurIPS 2025**.
5. **Chenlong Zhang**, Tong Zhou, Pengfei Cao, Zhuoran Jin, Yubo Chen, Kang Liu and Jun Zhao. [DTELS: Towards Dynamic Granularity of Timeline Summarization](#). Accepted to **NAACL 2025 Main**.
6. **Chenlong Zhang**, Pengfei Cao, Yubo Chen, Kang Liu, Zhiqiang Zhang, Mengshu Sun and Jun Zhao. [Continual Few-shot Event Detection via Hierarchical Augmentation Networks](#). Accepted to **COLING 2024 Main**.

## PROJECTS

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### The Interplay of Pre-Training and Post-Training

Jun. 2025 – Nov. 2025

Work done with Prof. Xiang Yue and Graham Neubig at CMU.

This project establishes a controlled framework to study how reinforcement learning (RL) interacts with pre-training and mid-training in shaping the reasoning abilities of language models. Using synthetic mathematical tasks with explicit reasoning atoms and dependency graphs, it disentangles causal effects between pre-, mid-, and post-training. The results show that generalization depends on the synergy between data distributions, that RL extends reasoning only after core primitives are learned, and that a mid-training bridge greatly improves performance under fixed compute.

## HONORS AND AWARDS

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|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| China National Scholarship ( <b>Top 0.2% nationwide</b> ), Ministry of Education | Dec. 2025 |
| Merit Student, University of Chinese Academy of Sciences                         | May 2024  |
| Outstanding Graduate, Provincial Education Department                            | Jun. 2023 |
| Excellent Bachelor's Thesis Award, Henan University                              | Jun. 2023 |
| China National Scholarship ( <b>Top 0.2% nationwide</b> ), Ministry of Education | Dec. 2022 |
| Excellent Completion, National Undergraduate Innovation Program (Leader)         | Apr. 2022 |
| China National Scholarship ( <b>Top 0.2% nationwide</b> ), Ministry of Education | Dec. 2021 |
| Bluesky Scholarship ( <b>Top 0.5%</b> ), Henan University                        | Jan. 2021 |
| China National Scholarship ( <b>Top 0.2% nationwide</b> ), Ministry of Education | Dec. 2020 |

## ACADEMIC SERVICES

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I actively serve in the NLP community as a shared task organizer and reviewer.

- Task Organizer, **SemEval 2026**: *Abductive Event Reasoning: Towards Real-World Event Causal Inference for Large Language LLMs*
- Task Organizer, **CCKS 2025**: *Event Timeline Generation for Social Media*
- Conference Reviewer: **NLPCC 2025**, **ACL**